

MIMAMSA (MĪMĀMSĀ)

VEDIC DUTY AND INJUNCTION → VALIDITY AND KNOWLEDGE SOURCES → POSTULATION AND NON-COGNITION → SELF-AWARENESS AND ERROR → WORD AND SENTENCE MEANING → VEDIC AUTHORLESSNESS AND GOD

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

VEDIC DUTY AND INJUNCTION

VEDIC DUTY AND INJUNCTION

KNOWING WHAT OUGHT TO BE DONE

VEDIC DUTY (DHARMA) IS KNOWN THROUGH INJUNCTION (CODANĀ), NOT

IMPELLING FORCE (BHĀVANĀ)

RITUAL ACTION

UNSEEN RITUAL POTENCY (APŪRVA)

DELAYED RESULT CORE CLAIM

OBJECTIVE NORMATIVITY DOES NOT REQUIRE A DIVINE COMMANDER

MIMAMSA: KNOWING WHAT OUGHT TO BE DONE

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- MIMAMSA: KNOWING WHAT OUGHT TO BE DONE
- Vedic duty (dharma) is known through injunction (codanā), not perception prescriptive sentence → impelling force (bhāvanā) → ritual action

Vedic duty (dharma) is known through injunction (codanā), not perception prescriptive sentence → impelling force

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- unseen ritual potency (apūrva) → delayed result core claim: objective normativity does not require a divine commander
- MIMAMSA: KNOWING WHAT OUGHT TO BE DONE

unseen ritual potency (apūrva) → delayed result core claim: objective normativity does not require a

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- Vedic duty (dharma) is known through injunction (codanā), not perception prescriptive sentence → impelling force (bhāvanā) → ritual action
- unseen ritual potency (apūrva) → delayed result core claim: objective normativity does not require a divine commander

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: objective normativity does not require a divine commander.

01

STAGE 01

VALIDITY AND KNOWLEDGE SOURCES

VALIDITY AND KNOWLEDGE SOURCES

INTRINSIC VALIDITY (SVATAḤ-PRĀMĀNYA) COGNITION PRESENTS ITSELF AS TRUE UNLESS

BHATTA ACCEPTS SIX SOURCES; PRABHAKARA DOES NOT TREAT NON-COGNITION

NYAYA CONTRAST

EXTERNAL VALIDATION (PARATAḤ-PRĀMĀNYA) REGRESS PRESSURE SUPPORTS FIRST-TRUST, BUT CORRECTION

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

INTRINSIC VALIDITY (SVATAḤ-PRĀMĀNYA) cognition presents itself as true unless a later defeater establishes error

Bhatta accepts six sources; Prabhakara does not treat non-cognition independently

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

Nyaya contrast → external validation (parataḥ-prāmānya) regress pressure supports first-trust, but correction still requires defeat

INTRINSIC VALIDITY (SVATAḤ-PRĀMĀNYA) cognition presents itself as true unless a later defeater establishes error

EVALUATION / TRAP

Bhatta accepts six sources; Prabhakara does not treat non-cognition independently

Nyaya contrast → external validation (parataḥ-prāmānya) regress pressure supports first-trust, but correction still requires defeat

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- INTRINSIC VALIDITY (SVATAḤ-PRĀMĀNYA) cognition presents itself as true unless a later defeater establishes error
- Bhatta accepts six sources; Prabhakara does not treat non-cognition independently

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- Nyaya contrast → external validation (parataḥ-prāmānya) regress pressure supports first-trust, but correction still requires defeat
- INTRINSIC VALIDITY (SVATAḤ-PRĀMĀNYA) cognition presents itself as true unless a later defeater establishes error

EVALUATION / TRAP

- Bhatta accepts six sources; Prabhakara does not treat non-cognition independently
- Nyaya contrast → external validation (parataḥ-prāmānya) regress pressure supports first-trust, but correction still requires defeat

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nyaya contrast → external validation (parataḥ-prāmānya) regress pressure supports first-trust, but correction still requires defeat.

02

STAGE 02

POSTULATION AND NON-COGNITION

POSTULATION AND NON-COGNITION

POSTULATION (ARTHĀPATTI)

EXPLANATORY FACT REQUIRED BY OTHERWISE CONFLICTING FACTS

DEVADATTA IS STOUT + DOES NOT EAT BY DAY

HE EATS AT NIGHT

NON-COGNITION (ANUPALABDHI)

KNOWLEDGE OF AN ELIGIBLE ABSENCE EMPTY FLOOR IS SEEN

POSTULATION IS NOT LOOSE GUESSING; NON-COGNITION IS NOT SIMPLE

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

POSTULATION (ARTHĀPATTI); EXPLANATORY FACT REQUIRED BY OTHERWISE CONFLICTING FACTS

Devadatta is stout + does not eat by day → he eats at night

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

NON-COGNITION (ANUPALABDHI); KNOWLEDGE OF AN ELIGIBLE ABSENCE empty floor is seen under conditions in which the pot would

non-cognition is not simple inattention

EVALUATION / TRAP

POSTULATION (ARTHĀPATTI); EXPLANATORY FACT REQUIRED BY OTHERWISE CONFLICTING FACTS

Devadatta is stout + does not eat by day → he eats at night

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- POSTULATION (ARTHĀPATTI); EXPLANATORY FACT REQUIRED BY OTHERWISE CONFLICTING FACTS
- Devadatta is stout + does not eat by day → he eats at night

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- NON-COGNITION (ANUPALABDHI); KNOWLEDGE OF AN ELIGIBLE ABSENCE empty floor is seen under conditions in which the pot would
- non-cognition is not simple inattention

EVALUATION / TRAP

- POSTULATION (ARTHĀPATTI); EXPLANATORY FACT REQUIRED BY OTHERWISE CONFLICTING FACTS
- Devadatta is stout + does not eat by day → he eats at night

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: KNOWLEDGE OF AN ELIGIBLE ABSENCE empty floor is seen under conditions in which the pot would have been seen trap: postulation is not loose guessing; non-cognition is not simple inattention.

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
POSTULATION (ARTHĀPATTI): EXPLANATORY FACT REQUIRED BY OTHERWISE CONFLICTING FACTS	NON-COGNITION (ANUPALABDHI): KNOWLEDGE OF AN ELIGIBLE ABSENCE empty floor is seen under conditions in which the pot would	POSTULATION (ARTHĀPATTI): EXPLANATORY FACT REQUIRED BY OTHERWISE CONFLICTING FACTS
Devadatta is stout + does not eat by day → he eats at night	non-cognition is not simple inattention	Devadatta is stout + does not eat by day → he eats at night
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03

STAGE 03 SELF-AWARENESS AND ERROR				
SELF-AWARENESS AND ERROR		THREEFOLD AWARENESS (TRIPUṬĪ-SAMVIT) ONE COGNITION DISCLOSES KNOWER, KNOWN AND	KNOWNNESS (JÑĀTATĀ) REVEALS THAT COGNITION OCCURRED ERROR	NON-DISCRIMINATION THEORY VERSUS CONTRARY-COGNITION THEORY BOTH AVOID AN INFINITE
SOURCE / DOCTRINE		ARGUMENT / MECHANISM		IMPLICATION / VERDICT
• PRABHAKARA: THREEFOLD AWARENESS (TRIPUṬĪ-SAMVIT) one cognition discloses knower, known and knowing together • BHATTA: KNOWNNESS (JÑĀTATĀ) REVEALS THAT COGNITION OCCURRED error → non-discrimination theory versus		• contrary-cognition theory both avoid an infinite second-cognition regress by different strategies • PRABHAKARA: THREEFOLD AWARENESS (TRIPUṬĪ-SAMVIT) one cognition discloses knower, known and knowing together		• BHATTA: KNOWNNESS (JÑĀTATĀ) REVEALS THAT COGNITION OCCURRED error → non-discrimination theory versus • contrary-cognition theory both avoid an infinite second-cognition regress by different strategies
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BHATTA: KNOWNNESS (JÑĀTATĀ) REVEALS THAT COGNITION OCCURRED error → non-discrimination theory versus contrary-cognition theory both avoid an infinite second-cognition regress by different strategies.				

04

STAGE 04

WORD AND SENTENCE MEANING

WORD AND SENTENCE MEANING

SENTENCE UNITY NEEDS EXPECTANCY + COMPATIBILITY + PROXIMITY DESIGNATION-THEN-CONNECTION

WORDS FIRST DENOTE, THEN MEANINGS COMBINE CONNECTED-DESIGNATION

WORDS DIRECTLY PRESENT MEANINGS ALREADY RELATED

VEDIC HERMENEUTICS RANKS INJUNCTION, EXPLANATORY PRAISE AND CONTEXTUAL INDICATORS

SENTENCE UNITY NEEDS EXPECTANCY + COMPATIBILITY + PROXIMITY designation-then-connection: words first

denote, then meanings combine connected-designation: words directly present meanings already related

Vedic hermeneutics ranks injunction, explanatory praise and contextual indicators semantic theory protects action-guiding scripture without

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

SENTENCE UNITY NEEDS EXPECTANCY + COMPATIBILITY + PROXIMITY designation-then-connection: words first

denote, then meanings combine connected-designation: words directly present meanings already related

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

Vedic hermeneutics ranks injunction, explanatory praise and contextual indicators semantic theory protects action-guiding scripture without an original speaker

SENTENCE UNITY NEEDS EXPECTANCY + COMPATIBILITY + PROXIMITY designation-then-connection: words first

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

denote, then meanings combine connected-designation: words directly present meanings already related

Vedic hermeneutics ranks injunction, explanatory praise and contextual indicators semantic theory protects action-guiding scripture without an original speaker

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Vedic hermeneutics ranks injunction, explanatory praise and contextual indicators semantic theory protects action-guiding scripture without an original speaker.

05

STAGE 05

VEDIC AUTHORLESSNESS AND GOD

VEDIC AUTHORLESSNESS AND GOD

VEDIC AUTHORLESSNESS (APĀURUṢEYATVA) BLOCKS HUMAN ERROR AT THE SOURCE

NYAYA GROUNDS SCRIPTURE IN A TRUSTWORTHY DIVINE SPEAKER; MIMAMSA

GOD IS UNNECESSARY FOR VEDIC AUTHORITY, RITUAL EFFICACY OR

REMOVING AN AUTHOR SECURES AUTONOMY BUT COMPLICATES SEMANTIC INTENTION

VEDIC AUTHORLESSNESS (APĀURUṢEYATVA) BLOCKS HUMAN ERROR AT THE SOURCE
eternity of word supports an uncreated

Nyaya grounds scripture in a trustworthy divine speaker; Mimamsa does not

God is unnecessary for Vedic authority, ritual efficacy or karmic distribution

pressure: removing an author secures autonomy but complicates semantic intention

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- VEDIC AUTHORLESSNESS (APĀURUṢEYATVA) BLOCKS HUMAN ERROR AT THE SOURCE
eternity of word supports an uncreated relation between word and meaning
- Nyaya grounds scripture in a trustworthy divine speaker; Mimamsa does not

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- God is unnecessary for Vedic authority, ritual efficacy or karmic distribution
- pressure: removing an author secures autonomy but complicates semantic intention

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VEDIC AUTHORLESSNESS (APĀURUṢEYATVA) BLOCKS HUMAN ERROR AT THE SOURCE
eternity of word supports an uncreated relation between word and meaning
- Nyaya grounds scripture in a trustworthy divine speaker; Mimamsa does not

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: God is unnecessary for Vedic authority, ritual efficacy or karmic distribution pressure: removing an author secures autonomy but complicates semantic intention.

06

STAGE 06	SELF, LIBERATION AND CRITICISM		
SELF, LIBERATION AND CRITICISM	ENDURING SELF SUPPORTS MEMORY, AGENCY, DESERT AND REBIRTH LIBERATION	CESSATION OF EMBODIMENT, PAIN AND ACTION-PRODUCING CONDITIONS STRENGTH	SOPHISTICATED EPISTEMOLOGY, SEMANTICS AND NON-THEISTIC NORMATIVITY LIMIT

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- VEDIC AUTHORLESSNESS (APAURUṢĒYATVA) BLOCKS HUMAN ERROR AT THE SOURCE eternity of word supports an uncreated relation between word and meaning
- Nyaya grounds scripture in a trustworthy divine speaker; Mimamsa does not

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- God is unnecessary for Vedic authority, ritual efficacy or karmic distribution
- pressure: removing an author secures autonomy but complicates semantic intention

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VEDIC AUTHORLESSNESS (APAURUṢĒYATVA) BLOCKS HUMAN ERROR AT THE SOURCE eternity of word supports an uncreated relation between word and meaning
- Nyaya grounds scripture in a trustworthy divine speaker; Mimamsa does not

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: God is unnecessary for Vedic authority, ritual efficacy or karmic distribution pressure: removing an author secures autonomy but complicates semantic intention.

06

STAGE 06

SELF, LIBERATION AND CRITICISM

SELF, LIBERATION AND CRITICISM

ENDURING SELF SUPPORTS MEMORY, AGENCY, DESERT AND REBIRTH LIBERATION

CESSATION OF EMBODIMENT, PAIN AND ACTION-PRODUCING CONDITIONS STRENGTH

SOPHISTICATED EPISTEMOLOGY, SEMANTICS AND NON-THEISTIC NORMATIVITY LIMIT

RITUAL CENTRALITY AND UNSEEN POTENCY INVITE VERIFICATION OBJECTIONS REPLY

DUTY IS KNOWN FROM THE VEDA BECAUSE ORDINARY SOURCES

ENDURING SELF SUPPORTS MEMORY, AGENCY, DESERT AND REBIRTH liberation = cessation of embodiment, pain and

conditions strength: sophisticated epistemology, semantics and non-theistic normativity limit: ritual centrality and unseen potency invite

objections reply: duty is known from the Veda because ordinary sources cannot disclose it

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- ENDURING SELF SUPPORTS MEMORY, AGENCY, DESERT AND REBIRTH liberation = cessation of embodiment, pain and action-producing
- conditions strength: sophisticated epistemology, semantics and non-theistic normativity limit: ritual centrality and unseen potency invite verification

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- objections reply: duty is known from the Veda because ordinary sources cannot disclose it
- ENDURING SELF SUPPORTS MEMORY, AGENCY, DESERT AND REBIRTH liberation = cessation of embodiment, pain and action-producing

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- conditions strength: sophisticated epistemology, semantics and non-theistic normativity limit: ritual centrality and unseen potency invite verification
- objections reply: duty is known from the Veda because ordinary sources cannot disclose it

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ENDURING SELF SUPPORTS MEMORY, AGENCY, DESERT AND REBIRTH liberation = cessation of embodiment, pain and action-producing conditions strength: sophisticated epistemology, semantics and non-theistic normativity limit: ritual centrality and unseen potency invite verification objections reply: duty is known from the Veda because ordinary sources cannot disclose it.

07

STAGE 07

PYQ ANSWER SYNTHESIS

PYQ ANSWER SYNTHESIS

IDENTIFY BHATTA

PRABHAKARA BEFORE WRITING STATE DOCTRINE

GIVE CANONICAL EXAMPLE

CONTRAST NYAYA

ASSESS RESIDUAL ISSUE LINK INTRINSIC VALIDITY TO POSTULATION, NON-COGNITION

POWERFUL THEORY OF KNOWLEDGE AND DUTY, CONTESTED RITUAL METAPHYSICS

IDENTIFY BHATTA / PRABHAKARA BEFORE WRITING state doctrine → give canonical example → contrast Nyaya

assess residual issue link intrinsic validity to postulation, non-cognition and Vedic authority use exact terminology

after the English concept verdict: powerful theory of knowledge and duty, contested ritual metaphysics

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- IDENTIFY BHATTA / PRABHAKARA BEFORE WRITING state doctrine → give canonical example → contrast Nyaya →
- assess residual issue link intrinsic validity to postulation, non-cognition and Vedic authority use exact terminology only

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- after the English concept verdict: powerful theory of knowledge and duty, contested ritual metaphysics
- IDENTIFY BHATTA / PRABHAKARA BEFORE WRITING state doctrine → give canonical example → contrast Nyaya →

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- assess residual issue link intrinsic validity to postulation, non-cognition and Vedic authority use exact terminology only
- after the English concept verdict: powerful theory of knowledge and duty, contested ritual metaphysics

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: powerful theory of knowledge and duty, contested ritual metaphysics.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

OPTIONAL DEPTH 1 — THE MIMAMSA PROJECT

KNOWLEDGE IN THE SERVICE OF VEDIC DUTY (DHARMA)

OPTIONAL DEPTH 2 — INTRINSIC VALIDITY AND THE MEANS

OPTIONAL DEPTH 3 — POSTULATION (ARTHĀPATTI) AND NON-COGNITION (ANUPALABDHI)

EXPLANATORY NECESSITY AND ABSENCE

OPTIONAL DEPTH 4 — SELF-AWARENESS AND ERROR

TRIPUTĪ, KNOWNNESS (JÑĀTATĀ) AND TWO MIMAMSA THEORIES

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- OPTIONAL DEPTH 1 — The Mimamsa Project: Knowledge in the Service of Vedic duty (dharma)
- OPTIONAL DEPTH 2 — Intrinsic Validity and the Means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) Architecture
- OPTIONAL DEPTH 3 — Postulation (arthāpatti) and Non-cognition (anupalabdhi): Explanatory Necessity and Absence
- OPTIONAL DEPTH 4 — Self-Awareness and Error: Tripuṭi, Knownness (jñātātā) and Two Mimamsa Theories

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- OPTIONAL DEPTH 5 — Word Meaning, Sentence Meaning and Ritual Hermeneutics
- OPTIONAL DEPTH 6 — Authorless Veda, Anti-Theism, Action and moral consequence (karma) and Later Liberation (mokṣa)
- OPTIONAL DEPTH 7 — Comparisons, Criticisms, Traps and the Contemporary Sanskrit Context
- OPTIONAL DEPTH 8 — PYQ Routing, Answer Architecture and Complete Exam Deployment

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- OPTIONAL DEPTH 1 — The Mimamsa Project: Knowledge in the Service of Vedic duty
- (dharma) Advanced normativity without divine command The school's unity lies in its governing problem.
- Vedic duty (dharma) cannot be perceived, while ordinary inference cannot independently establish ritual obligation.
- Vedic injunction therefore supplies normative knowledge, semantics explains sentence-unity, and unseen ritual potency (apūrva) explains delayed efficacy.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.